

Google Privacy Policy Analysis

Date Accepted: 2015

Data Collection Practices

Collection spans account info, activity data (search terms, watch history, purchases, call/message logs where applicable), device data (browser, OS, IP, hardware identifiers), location (GPS, IP, Wi-Fi/cell-tower proximity), and content (emails, photos, docs) one of the broadest single-account footprints reviewed, consistent with Google's multi-product ecosystem (Search, Gmail, Android, Maps, Assistant). Google frames this transparently around a "trust" narrative and explicitly separates products used while signed in vs. signed out.

Data Sharing Policies

Google states that "We do not share your personal information with companies, organisations or individuals outside of Google except in the following cases" consent, domain administrators (for school/work accounts, who can access account email, view stats, and even restrict a user's own ability to delete data or change privacy settings a meaningful limitation for managed/edu accounts), external processors under contract, and legal reasons (law enforcement, ToS enforcement, fraud/security, protecting rights). Google explicitly states it does not "sell" personal information and does not "share" it as CCPA defines that term a direct, legally precise claim not made this specifically by Amazon, Meta, or Netflix.

User Rights

Extensive built-in tooling: Activity Controls, Shared Endorsements settings, My Ad Centre, and a full "Privacy Controls" hub. Under US state laws Google discloses rights to access (in portable format), correct, delete, and opt out of profiling/targeted advertising, plus non-discrimination and separately calls out heightened protections for health data under the Washington My Health My Data Act and Nevada SB 370, a level of state-law specificity none of the other 8 policies match.

Opt-Out Provisions

- Export data anytime ("Takeout"-style export).
- Delete specific content, specific products, or the entire account.
- Inactive Account Manager: lets a user pre-designate a trusted contact or auto-delete if the account goes dormant a unique feature among the services reviewed.
- Browser/device-level cookie and location controls.
- Domain administrators can override/restrict some of these controls for managed accounts a caveat students should be aware of for school Google accounts specifically.

Update Procedures

Google states it "regularly reviews" the policy for compliance but the excerpted sections don't specify an active-notification commitment for changes (e.g., email or in-product banner) comparable to Amazon's passive model rather than Riot Games' or Netflix's stated "additional notice for material changes" commitment.

Summary

Attribute	Rating
Transparency of collection practices	High
Sharing disclosure	High (explicit “we do not sell/share” language, named exceptions)
User rights clarity	High (state-law-specific carve-outs, e.g., health data)
Opt-out ease	High (centralized Privacy Controls hub, unique Inactive Account Manager)
Update transparency	Medium (no explicit active-notification commitment found)